

KALE REALTY

YOU TOLD A BUYER **RATES** **WOULD DROP.**

They just moved the other way, for the first time all year.

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MORTGAGE RATES BROKE BACK ABOVE 7 PERCENT THIS WEEK.

After staying under that line since January, a geopolitical shock pushed the number up. That's this week's buyer conversation, not last month's.

THE RATE ISN'T THE PROBLEM ANYMORE. THE WAITING IS.

HousingWire's weekly mortgage rate tracker put the average at 7.12 percent for the week ending September 11, 2026, the first time this year the number moved back above 7 percent after favorable mortgage spreads had held it under that line since January. The move followed an escalation in the Iran conflict, which pushed the 10-year Treasury yield higher. HousingWire's Logan Mohtashami notes that housing demand tends to fade once rates cross roughly 6.64 percent and keeps fading the further above 7 percent they go. A buyer who has spent the year hearing "rates will come down eventually" just watched the number move the wrong direction, and the agent still repeating that line is coaching a plan the data no longer backs.

RESET THE BUYER CONVERSATION THIS WEEK:

- 1** Say today's number, not the memory of an old one.
7.12 percent as of last week, not the
- 2** 99 percent low from earlier this year they're still anchored to.
- 3** Ask what they can actually afford at today's rate.
Not the payment they calculated in the
- 4** spring.
- 5** Put a rate buydown or lender credit on the table now
, instead of an open-ended "wait and
- 6** see."
- 7** Set an actual re-check date on the calendar.
Not "whenever rates come down." A specific
- 8** week beats an indefinite wait every time.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE OLD RATE ISN'T COMING BACK ON YOUR BUYER'S TIMELINE.

Have the today's-number conversation before they read the headline themselves.